The aid given by the US, European and other foreign governments for the development of FATA could not reach there. The younger generation was utterly frustrated due to insecurity, as well as lack of educational and recreational facilities (*The Daily Times*, 2010).

For these reasons, historical and current, FATA became a hub of terrorists from all over the region. These elements mostly remained unchallenged by the state. Until 2014, they flourished in this ungoverned area. Several military operations failed to dislodge them. However, the military operation 'Zarb-e-Azb' was a serious effort that destroyed their command and control structures and flushed them out of FATA. Unfortunately, a large number of these elements sneaked into Afghanistan through the porous Pak–Afghan border and sheltered in the Kunar and Nuristan provinces of Afghanistan.

Madrasahs

After the 9/11 attack, the *madaris* (plural of madrasah – a religious seminary) in Pakistan were alleged to be protectors of terrorists in Pakistan. The Taliban (students) who had emerged from the *madaris* established themselves in Afghan refugee camps in tribal areas of Pakistan during the Afghan jihad and changed the Western perception about the 1,000-year-old institution of Islamic teaching (Fair, 2009). They were considered the breeding ground of the Jihadi culture – a term used for Islamic militancy in the English-language press of Pakistan. Darul Uloom Haqqania, Akora Khattak, KP, where Mullah Omar received education, was termed by Western journalists as the 'University of Jihad' (Ahmad, 2000). In addition to madrasahs, religious and jihadi parties were instrumental in creating the jihadi culture. The dauntingly long list of religious, sectarian and jihadi parties gave a clear but dismal picture that showed how easy and convenient it was to raise and run such organisations (Rana, 2009).

Madrasah was a key educational institution of Islamic teachings, which had a long history in the Islamic world and in the Indo-Pak sub-continent. It offered different programmes ranging from learning Qur'an (Tajweed) to Hifz-e-Qur'an (Learning Qur'an by heart) and the Dars-e-Nizami degree for full-fledged religious scholars. The curriculum covered Islamic philosophy and logic, Qur'an, *Hadith* and *fiqh* and Arabic grammar. Students study for free and are awarded graduate qualifications after eight years. Funding to run this school comes from charity.